Q+A

CUPID CALLING

Matchmaker **Sima Taparia** is on a roll with a new season of *Indian Matchmaking* on Netflix, brand endorsements, speaking engagements and, of course, loads of matchmaking

India's favourite matchmaker **Sima Aunty** is back for another season



Q. What can we look forward to in season 3 of *Indian Matchmaking*?
In the new season, you will see success stories, my family time, travels with my husband, and a new country. I'm also busier than ever with matchmaking and have had to expand my office to deal with the many new enquiries.

Q. The show has been criticised for not being progressive and promoting old-fashioned values. Do you agree?
I am a typical Indian woman and I respect Indian values of sharing, shedding ego, understanding, and giving space to your spouse. They are important for a successful, married life. And marriage will remain with humans on this earth.

Q. When did you decide to become a matchmaker?
I was interested in socialising since childhood.... Twenty-six years ago, I did a match for my own sister, who is now happily married. Then I thought this is a social need and started suggesting matches for family and friends. Since 2005, I've been doing it professionally.

Q. A piece of advice you repeatedly give is: "You have to be willing to compromise." Why aren't clients on the show listening?
People are the same across the world.... Overall, they want their criteria to be matched. My advice is to go forward when you get a 60-70 per cent match—because no one can be a 100 per cent match. Gen Z is changing after watching the show and wants to opt for arranged marriage. Youngsters have loved 'Sima Aunty's' advice. They see that they're getting everything as if from a menu, and I'm receiving enquiries daily.

with Amit Dixit